

3.1 Techniques used to check and review visual imaging portfolios

Techniques to check the technical properties of visual imaging portfolios

- Methods of checking
 - checklist
- Elements of visual imaging portfolio to check
 - file size, properties and format
 - playback testing for display size and media compatibility

Techniques to review the fitness for purpose of visual imaging portfolios

- Suitability for client requirements
- Suitability for target audience
 - suitability of content
 - accessibility
- Review of visual quality, aesthetics, appeal and engagement

To include:

- The structure, content and use of checklists
- Checking the suitability of resolutions and file formats used for portfolios of photographs for different devices, platforms and products e.g. print publishing, digital graphics
- Checking running time, audio volume and onscreen duration of content for comprehension by audiences
- Checking the suitability of file sizes and formats used for video sequences for different devices, platforms and distribution channels

Does not include:

- Detailed use of formal test tables to document checks, noise (luminance or colour), peer or client testing/focus group feedback

To include:

- Strengths and weaknesses of created visual imaging products
- Comparing completed created visual imaging products against client briefs, client requirement lists or success criteria
- Assessing the appropriateness of chosen visual style and approaches/ conventions for clients and target audiences
- Assessing fitness for purpose e.g. an advert should advertise; a promotion should promote

Does not include:

- Client /peer/focus group feedback or review, questionnaires, vox pop

Unit R098: Visual imaging

3.2 Improvements and further developments

Constraints which limit the effectiveness of visual imaging portfolios

- Visual imaging portfolio constraints
 - time
 - resources
 - hardware
 - software
 - skills
- Visual imaging portfolio improvements
 - Using camera settings
 - composition
 - stability of video
 - image processing
 - video editing

Further development opportunities for a visual imaging portfolio

- Further developments
 - length
 - product type and placement
 - story/narrative content
 - reuse of components
 - cross platform media

To include:

- How the quality of visual imaging portfolios is constrained by time, resources, hardware, software, budget, legislation, skills
- The feasible improvements to visual imaging portfolios in terms of client requirements and target audience engagement

To include:

- How successful visual imaging portfolios can lead to repeat business/further commissions from clients
- How different resources, software, budget and skills could help portfolios to be developed further
- How to devise further developments in terms of client requirements and target audience

Marking criteria

[Section 6.4](#) provides full information on how to mark the NEA units and apply the marking criteria. The marking criteria descriptor words are further explained in [Appendix B](#).

The tables below contain the marking criteria for the tasks for this unit. If a student's work does not meet any Mark Band 1 (MB1) criteria for the task, you must award zero marks for that task.

Unit R098 – Topic Area 1: Plan visual imaging portfolios		
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Produces a basic interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is limited .	Produces an adequate interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is sound .	Produces an effective interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is comprehensive .
MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–8 marks
Produces basic pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of few elements of the final product.	Produces adequate pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of some elements of the final product.	Produces detailed pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of all elements of the final product.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Demonstrates limited understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.	Demonstrates sound understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.	Demonstrates comprehensive understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.

MB1: 1–4 marks	MB2: 5–8 marks	MB3: 9–12 marks
Use of technical skills to create the component parts is limited in its effectiveness. Conventions and creativity in the components are limited in their fitness for purpose. The range of components supports the creation of the final product in a limited way.	Use of technical skills to create the component parts is partly effective. Conventions and creativity in the components are adequate in their fitness for purpose. The range of components partly supports the creation of the final product.	Use of technical skills to create the component parts is effective. Conventions and creativity in the components are fully fit for purpose. The range of components fully supports the creation of the final product.
MB1: 1–5 marks	MB2: 6–10 marks	MB3: 11–14 marks
Use of technical skills to create the final product is limited in its effectiveness. Conventions and creativity are applied in the final product in a limited way. Final product is limited in its fitness for purpose.	Use of technical skills to create the final product is partly effective. Conventions and creativity are adequately applied in the final product. Final product is adequately fit for purpose.	Use of technical skills to create the final product is effective. Conventions and creativity are effectively applied in the final product. Final product is fully fit for purpose.
MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–8 marks
Formats of the saved/exported components are limited in their appropriateness. Properties and format(s) of the final product are limited in their appropriateness.	Formats of the saved/exported components are adequate in their appropriateness. Properties and format(s) of the final product are adequate in their appropriateness.	Formats of the saved/exported components are clearly appropriate. Properties and format(s) of the final product are clearly appropriate.

MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–7 marks	MB3: 8–10 marks
Testing/checking is limited in its effectiveness in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates limited understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.	Testing/checking is partly effective in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates sound understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.	Testing/checking is fully effective in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates critical understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Recommendations demonstrate limited understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations have limited explanation.	Recommendations demonstrate sound understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations are partly explained.	Recommendations demonstrate comprehensive understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations are fully explained.

Assessment guidance

Task	Assessment guidance
Task 1	Strand 1a For Mark Band (MB)1, students may have simply stated the chosen audience and restated the client. To be credited in the higher mark bands, students would need to include evidence of generating and describing appropriate ideas which meet the client requirements and appeal to the target audience for both the photographs and video sequence. A detailed explanation of why the intended style of photographs and content/sequence of video would be suitable for the client may be appropriate for the higher mark bands. If only one aspect is explained in detail, then best fit would enable access to MB2 at best. Diagrammatic representations would illustrate the interpretation but would not be sufficient on their own to fulfil the requirement to explain for the upper mark bands. When interpreting the brief, students need to make decisions independently. Although it is to be expected that different students may make similar decisions and develop similar ideas, it would be highly unusual for all students in a cohort to have identical work.

Strand 1b

Pre-production documentation for the photographs and video could be presented in a number of different formats. The breadth of pre-production planning covers both the capturing of materials and editing into final products. If only one is planned effectively then best fit would enable access to MB2 at best. It would be unlikely for any single pre-production document to cover 'all' elements of the capturing of final photographs and capturing and editing of video footage, and different types of planning document would be expected in order to meet the criteria for the upper mark bands.

Students must not be directed to complete specific planning tasks but may be referred to the teaching and learning content for the unit. When planning their visual imaging products and justifying their design choices, students need to make decisions independently. Although it is to be expected that different students may make similar decisions and develop similar ideas, it would be highly unusual for all students in a cohort to have identical work.

Strand 1c

This strand assesses how the assets contribute to the effectiveness of the final product. For the purposes of this unit, the term 'assets' refers to the images and video that will be used in the final visual imaging portfolio of materials. A large part of these are being created in this assessment rather than sourced as a planning activity such that the task only refers to the video sequence. For this, additional content in the form of assets could be sourced to enhance the footage that is recorded. The evidence requires an understanding of how additional assets would contribute to the overall effectiveness, justifying any decisions that are made for the upper mark bands.

Task 2**Strand 2a**

The component parts in this instance are the photographs and recorded video footage. The technical skills are based on the camera settings, features used, video camera shots, stability and movement. Where the technical quality of the original photographs and video may only be evidenced by looking at the files, this would have a partial contribution around MB1 or possibly MB2. However, more explicit evidence would be needed for high MB2 and MB3. The use of a camera in a fully automatic 'point and shoot' photographic mode would be appropriate in MB1 whereas evidence of choosing and using advanced camera settings is needed for the upper mark bands. For video, the use of a range of appropriate shot types, camera angles and movements would contribute towards upper the mark bands. Fitness for purpose in terms of the conventions in the components is assessed through the visual aspects and composition of the photographs and video. A basic set of photographs with a similar subject/composition would be appropriate for MB1 whereas for the upper mark bands, different compositions and use of the rules of photography would be required. Creativity can be assessed such that artistic viewpoints and compositions would contribute to the higher mark band. For video, the shot angle and visual impact would contribute, especially where the shots demonstrate a strong visual impact that gives meaning to achieve MB3. The subject content in the photographs and video should be a good match for the set scenario for the upper mark bands when considering the range of components and their suitability to meet the assignment brief and client requirements. Photographs or video which are 'off topic' would be appropriately assessed in MB1.

Strand 2b

The first descriptor assesses technical skills in the image processing and video editing. Implied evidence from the final images and video may still be credited within MB1 but evidence must be explicit for the upper mark bands. The conventions (e.g. composition) for photographic images would be assessed by their selection for use in the final portfolio. The conventions of the video are represented by the sequence, structure and timing. Creativity would be more about the content of the video, story and whether the final sequence is original and engaging for an audience. Fitness for purpose could be achieved by ensuring the final photographic portfolio and video sequence are a good match for the brief, meeting the client requirements and appeal for a target audience. If the products are a mismatch for the purpose, then MB1 may be appropriate. If both clearly meet the requirements, then MB3 may be appropriate.

When creating their visual imaging products, students must make decisions independently. They must apply what they have learnt and not be led through a process to create visual imaging products. Students must not be directed to use particular software or software tools and/or techniques.

Strand 2c

The first part of this task is to save and export both of the finished visual imaging products in a suitable format as required by the parameters in the scenario. Proprietary formats such as raw or video files within video editing software would be assessed in MB1 (external moderation should not be expected to be able to view these). Generic, widely supported image and video file formats would be required for both the photographic portfolio and video sequence to achieve the upper mark bands. If minimal or no consideration of quality settings with respect to the file properties of the photographic portfolio and video sequence is evident, MB1 would be appropriate.

When exporting their visual imaging products, students need to independently decide on suitable electronic formats and properties.

Task 3

Students must produce their own review. They must apply what they have learnt and not be led through a process of reviewing their completed visual imaging products.

Strand 3a

The nature of the checks for the first descriptor should be focused closely on reviewing the technical properties rather than visual content, especially to meet the higher mark band. The second descriptor assesses understanding of the effectiveness of the photographic portfolio and video sequence for the client and target audience. If only the client or target audience are considered, or if evidence that only states the materials meet the client requirements, a mark in MB1 may be suitable. An explanation, with reasons justifying any conclusions would be more appropriate to show understanding for MB3.

Strand 3b

This strand requires an understanding of what could be better in the materials produced for the brief together with opportunities to develop it more widely. A list of areas to improve could be credited in MB1 whereas an explanation of weaknesses, justifying how and why they could be better would be more appropriate for the upper mark bands. A similar assessment philosophy applies to the areas for further development, which is more about what else could be developed that would support the client and the product scenario. This should include both the photographic portfolio and video sequence for the upper mark bands. A list of recommendations for different ways to improve the materials and/or develop them further could be credited in MB1 but these would need to be supported by appropriate explanations for the higher mark band. Since there is no requirement for a prescribed number of improvements and developments, a few aspects considered and explained in extensive detail could nevertheless meet the criteria for MB3.

Topic Area		Topic Area	
1	Plan visual imaging portfolios	2	Factors influencing product design
		3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations
2	Create visual imaging portfolios	3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations
3	Review visual imaging portfolios	2	Factors influencing product design
		3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations

More information about synoptic assessment within this qualification can be found in [section 5.2 Synoptic assessment](#).